A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

16 April 2026

Physios at CMG

Dear Physios at CMG,

Re: Mr Filippo Lauricella
DOB: 1993-10-24
Address: 2/43 Wentworth Drive, Taylors Lakes, VIC, 3038

Thank you for reviewing Phil, a web designer who presents with a protracted and debilitating history of complex bowel and urinary symptoms. I am referring him to you for your expert assessment and management of suspected pelvic floor dyssynergia and visceral hypersensitivity, as he would greatly benefit from your integrated, psychologically-informed approach to pelvic health.

Clinical History

Phil reports a significant burden of disease, opening his bowels between five and eight times daily. His sessions on the toilet are protracted, typically lasting 30 to 60 minutes, and are characterised by significant straining and a persistent sense of incomplete evacuation. These symptoms appear to be heavily influenced by a gut-brain component; Phil identifies that stress is a major trigger for his urgency, often resulting in "bad days" where he feels unable to leave the house. This is particularly relevant currently as he is preparing for his wedding in May. Furthermore, he experiences significant urinary frequency and pelvic floor pain, with occasional bright red rectal bleeding noted on wiping, likely secondary to chronic straining.

Previous Interventions

Phil has previously engaged with pelvic floor physiotherapy where a "very tight pelvic floor" was identified. While he has trialled a TENS machine and various breath-work techniques, these have offered limited relief. He has not yet explored more advanced biofeedback or vibration-assisted therapies. Although he has a history of engaging with CBT for general anxiety, he has not had the opportunity to apply these principles specifically to his gut-related cognitions or his toilet-sitting behaviours.

Collaborative Request

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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Given your experience with complex functional cases, I would value your assessment and guidance on a comprehensive behavioural and physical programme for Phil. He is quite open to the "CBT for the gut" model, and I suspect he would benefit from your expertise in sensory retraining and evacuation mechanics—perhaps involving balloon biofeedback or vibration therapy if you deem it appropriate. My goal is to help him break the cycle of urgency and protracted toilet sessions through the kind of psychologically-minded physiotherapy your team provides.

Plan

From my end, I have advised Phil to cease artificial sweeteners (specifically Coke Zero and sugar-free mints) and have scheduled a gastroscopy and colonoscopy for after his wedding. We may consider the introduction of low-dose neuromodulators, such as nortriptyline, following his endoscopic review.

I look forward to your thoughts on his progress and would be grateful for your input in helping Phil improve his quality of life post his wedding.

Yours sincerely,

A/Prof Chamara Basnayake
Gastroenterologist

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